

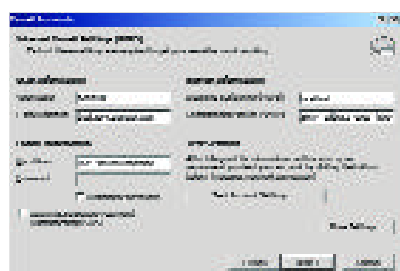
Installing and Configuring POPFile

There are a few key settings you need to adjust to make POPFile work for you. The process begins from the time you kick-start the installation.

STEP 1 The first significant step in the installation process is to select the program components. You can safely uncheck the Languages box. When it asks you to specify the ports for POP3 and the user interface connections, leave the settings as they are. If your mail client runs in the background all the time, check the box to make POPFile always start with Windows.

STEP 2 A bucket is the equivalent of a folder in an e-mail client. E-mail is sorted into buckets depending on its content, and the rules you teach it. By default, four buckets have already been created. You must have at least two buckets to use POPFile (to sort the good mail from the bad), so you can remove work and personal bucket, if you don't want a detailed classification of your e-mails.

STEP 3 Launch the application, in say Outlook 2002. Go to **Tools > E-mail Accounts**. Choose to modify your existing e-mail account. Now, in the POP3 field, change your server address to localhost. Then modify your username to the following



Change settings in the E-mail Accounts dialog box of Outlook 2002

format: **Server_address: username (e.g.: pop.mailserver.com:badjag)** Click on Next to finalise the changes. This causes POPFile to intercept requests for messages from the e-mail client and then connect to the server to download and process them. Remember,

POPFile must be active while your mail client is checking for new messages.

STEP 4 Launch the program in the background by clicking on the appropriate icon in the Start menu.

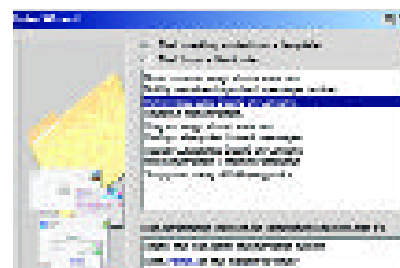
Double-click on the icon in the System Tray to launch the HTML interface. Now click on the Buckets link. Click the Turn On button under the Quarantine column for the spam bucket. This will bypass most of the tricks that the beastly spammers use to check if



The HTML interface for POPFile provides you with the configuration settings

your e-mail address is being actively used, thus making it a perfect target for even more spam. Turning on Quarantine converts the message to a harmless attachment, and fools the spammer into thinking the address isn't active. The Subject Modification column adds the bucket name in the message header for easy filtering in your mail client (e.g. [spam] is inserted in the subject line of messages that POPFile considers useless)

STEP 5 Back in Outlook, click on **Tools > Rules Wizard**. Choose your e-mail account in the drop-down box, and click on New. In the new window that pops up, select 'Move messages based on content'. Then click on the specific word's link. Add the same text that POPFile



Use the Rules Wizard in Outlook to set the rule to be applied to the received e-mail

uses to mark the message (e.g. [spam]) in the new box. Click on the Add button and then click OK. Now it's time to select which folder to move the marked messages to. Click on the specified link. You can either choose a folder from the list (move spam straight to the trash, for example) or create a folder to filter your other kinds of mail (work, personal, psychotic, etc). Click on Finish to cement the changes and get ready to enjoy a—relatively—spam-free life.

STEP 6 Here's where the fun part begins. Once POPFile begins intercepting requests for e-mails from the client, it displays messages from the last two days in the History section of the interface. You can change the number of days and the number of messages per page in the Configuration section. POPFile is a program that learns to differentiate between good and bad e-mails. As a result, it will be highly inaccurate in classifying the first few messages it receives. In fact, it actually leaves the very first batch of e-mails unclassified.

So this is what you've got to do. Look at the e-mail you've got and classify it using the dropdown box in the right-hand side of the window—if you haven't changed any of the default buckets, you can choose from inbox, spam, work, and personal. Starting with the next batch of e-mails you receive, POPFile will automatically try to classify it. If you find that it has classified something wrongly (or not at all), simply head back to the History section and point it in the right direction.

Give it some time and e-mails—the programmers recommend 100 e-mails before it achieves total accuracy, and then watch it filter out all that unwanted junk!

spam e-mail's instructions to reply with the word 'remove'. This is just a trick to get you to react to the e-mail. It informs the sender that the e-mail address is valid, which greatly increases its value. If you reply, your address is placed on more lists, and you receive more spam.

Also, avoid listing your e-mail ID on

Web pages, and if you do, make it difficult for spambots to harvest. E-mail IDs listed on Web sites are the main source for spammers. These listings make it easy for spambots to harvest them. However, you can list your e-mail IDs, and still make it difficult for spambots to detect. This can be done by using graphics

instead of text to display the e-mail addresses or by inserting spaces in the e-mail ID.

Web sites that promise to remove your name from spam lists are another sham. These sites are of two kinds: genuine and spammers. The first kind of site is ignored (or exploited), by the spammers, the sec-